MIL-B-37160A
30 August 1978
SUPERSEDING
MIL-B-37160
29 November 1974

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BUTALBITAL, ASPIRIN, CAFFEINE, AND PHENACETIN TABLETS

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers Butalbital, Aspirin, Caffeine, and Phenacetin Tablets.

1.2 Classification. The tablets covered by this specification shall be of the following sizes (see 6.2):

Size 1 - 30s
Size 2 - 1000s
Size 3 - individually sealed, 30s

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Hq, Defense Personnel Support Center, ATTN: Directorate of Medical Materiel, DPSC-ATT, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document, or by letter.

FSC 6505

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SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-C-186 -Containers, Packaging and Packing for Drugs, Chemicals and Pharmaceuticals.

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-140 -Tablets (for Medicinal Purposes).

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 -Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL-STD-129 -Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply.

U. S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH, EDUCATION, AND WELFARE, FOOD AND DRUG ADMINISTRATION (FDA)

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Food and Drug Administration, Washington, DC 20204.)

U. S. PHARMACOPEIAL CONVENTION, INC.

The United States Pharmacopeia (USP).

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, PA 18042.)

The National Formulary (NF).

(Applications for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, PA 18042.)

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Shall be Butalbital, Aspirin, Caffeine and Phenacetin Tablets and shall be in accordance with all applicable requirements of FED-STD-140, and as specified herein.

S2. Classification. Shall be type I.

S5.3 The following is added to this paragraph:

Shall be tablets containing 50 mg butalbital, 200 mg aspirin, 40 mg caffeine and 130 mg phenacetin, within the designated assay limits for the tablets.

S6.4.6 Hardness. The average hardness of the tablets shall be greater than 6, when determined using a calibrated Strong-Cobb hardness tester, or equivalent instrument giving comparable results. Twenty (20) tablets shall be tested and not more than 4 tablets may fall below the value of 6.

S6.4.9.1 Disintegration. Tablets shall comply with the following disintegration tests:

Disintegration time testing on the finished tablet shall be conducted in two stages: Immediately following manufacturing and at an interval of thirty (30) days. The test method employed shall be the USP Method for Uncoated Tablets in purified water at 37° C, using disks. Test criteria for disintegration shall be as follows:

(1) For initial test - less than 1 minute.
(2) After a thirty (30) day interval - less than 2 minutes.

3.1.1 Assays. The tablets shall assay to contain not less than 92.0 percent and not more than 108.0 percent of the required amounts of butalbital, aspirin, caffeine and phenacetin when assayed as specified in 4.5.1. As an alternate to the assays specified in 4.5.1, suitable, accurate and reproducible assay method(s) shall be used.

3.1.2 Identification. The tablets shall comply with the identity tests as specified in 4.5.2.

3.1.3 Free salicylic acid. At the time of manufacture, the free salicylic acid content of the finished tablets shall not be more than 0.30 percent of the required amount of aspirin when assayed as specified in 4.5.3. As an alternate to the assay specified in 4.5.3, a suitable, accurate and reproducible assay method may be used.

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3.2 Ingredients.

3.2.1 Aspirin, caffeine and phenacetin. The aspirin, caffeine and phenacetin used in the manufacture of the tablets shall comply with the tests, standards, and requirements of the USP, including any supplements or revisions thereto.

3.2.2 Butalbital. The butalbital used in the manufacture of the tablets shall comply with the tests, standards, and requirements of the NF XIII, which was official from 1 September 1970 to 30 June 1975.

3.3 Other ingredients. All other ingredients used in the manufacture of the tablets shall comply with S5.1 of FED-STD-140.

3.4 Expiration dating period. The expiration dating period shall be not less than 36 months.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Supplier responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and, (i) as to any expiration dated item, for the expiration dating period specified by the contractor for such item, or such longer period as may be required by regulation of any federal agency; or (ii) as to non-dated items, for not less than 3 years after delivery of the item to the Government.

4.1.2 No company supplying any ingredient(s) to the contractor will be considered an acceptable facility for the performance of any inspection requirements specified herein.

4.2 Sampling. The sampling as shown in FED-STD-140 shall be applicable.

4.3 Packaging inspection. The inspection of the intermediate package, packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

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4.4 Labeling inspection. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and the unit of product shall be the unit of issue. The inspection lot shall be the number of units of issue of each batch, lot, control number, etc., offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level for labeling shall be S-2 and the acceptance number shall be zero.

4.5 Tests.

4.5.1 Assays for active ingredients.

NOTE: Use water-washed solvents.

Reagents.

Sodium bicarbonate solution. Dissolve 8.4 grams of sodium bicarbonate in, and dilute to 100 ml with purified water.

Potassium phosphate solution. Dissolve 21.2 grams of potassium phosphate (tribasic) in, and dilute to 100 ml with purified water.

Sulfuric acid solution. Add 11 ml of concentrated sulfuric acid to about 80 ml of purified water. Allow to cool and dilute to 100 ml with purified water.

Ammonium hydroxide solution. Dilute 6.90 ml of concentrated ammonium hydroxide to 1000 ml with purified water.

Suitable chromatographic material, acid-washed (purified siliceous earth).

Chloroform. Reagent grade, freshly purified water-washed.

Ether. Freshly distilled ether (or from a freshly opened can), freshly purified water-washed.

Glacial acetic acid in chloroform, 10 percent (freshly prepared).

Dilute 10 ml of glacial acetic acid to 100 ml with purified water-washed chloroform.

Glacial acetic acid in chloroform, 1 percent (freshly prepared).

Dilute 5 ml of glacial acetic acid to 500 ml with purified water-washed chloroform.

Methanol, chromatographic grade, water-free.

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Procedure.

Preparation of the columns.

Column A. Pack a small pledget of glass wool in the base of a chromatographic tube having an inner diameter of 15 to 25 mm. To 3.0 grams of suitable chromatographic material, add 3.0 ml of the sodium bicarbonate solution, mix well, and transfer it to the chromatographic tube. Pack the chromatographic material down firmly with a glass tamping rod and cover with a pledget of glass wool.

Column B. Pack a small pledget of glass wool in the base of a chromatographic tube as above. To 2.0 grams of a suitable chromatographic material, add 2.0 ml of the sulfuric acid solution, mix well, and transfer it to the chromatographic tube. Pack down firmly with a glass tamping rod. Then, to 3.0 grams of the chromatographic material, add 3.0 ml of potassium phosphate solution, mix well, and transfer it to the column. Pack down the chromatographic material evenly and firmly with the glass tamping rod. Mount the chromatography columns on a stand in such a manner that the effluent from column A flows directly into column B, and finally into a receiver.

4.5.1.1 Aspirin. The finished tablets shall be assayed for aspirin, as follows:

NOTE: Use purified water-washed chloroform.

Reference standard.

Prepare a USP aspirin reference standard of a known final concentration of approximately 0.10 mg per ml, using one percent glacial acetic acid in chloroform as the solvent.

Procedure.

Grind 20 tablets to a fine powder in a mortar. Accurately weigh a sample of powder equivalent to approximately 100 mg of aspirin and transfer it to a 50 ml volumetric flask. Add about 25 ml of purified water-washed chloroform and 0.1 ml of glacial acetic acid and shake on the mechanical shaker for 15 minutes. Adjust the volume to 50 ml at room temperature with purified water-washed ether and mix well. Pipet 5.0 ml of the solution into a 50 ml calibrated graduated cylinder containing 40 ml of water-washed ether. This is the sample solution.

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Pass 25 ml of water-washed ether through the columns and discard the washings. Place a 250 ml Erlenmeyer flask under the columns and then pour the entire sample solution into Column A and allow the solvent to flow through both columns. Pass 3 consecutive 20 ml portions of water-washed ether through the columns, rinsing the graduated cylinder and the sides of the column. Retain the ether eluates for the phenacetin assay.

As soon as the third portion of ether has passed through column A, separate the columns and immediately start the elution of aspirin from column A.

Place a 100 ml volumetric flask under column A and wash the column with 10 ml of 10 percent glacial acetic acid in chloroform followed by 90 ml of 1 percent glacial acetic acid in chloroform.

Adjust the volume of the aspirin eluates from column A to 100 ml with chloroform and mix well.

Determine the maximum absorbance of the sample and standard at approximately 280 ~~mm~~ in 1 cm quartz cells, using a suitable spectrophotometer with chloroform as a blank.

Calculation:

$$\frac{Au}{As} \times \frac{S}{W} \times C \times 1000 = \text{mg of aspirin per tablet}$$

Au = absorbance of sample
As = absorbance of standard
S = average weight of sample per tablet, in grams
W = weight of sample powder used, in grams
C = concentration of aspirin standard in mg per ml

$$1000 = \text{dilution factor} = \frac{50 \times 100}{5}$$

4.5.1.2 Phenacetin. The finished tablets shall be assayed for phenacetin, as follows:

Reference standard.

Prepare a reference standard solution containing phenacetin, USP reference standard, of a known, final concentration of approximately 0.013 mg per ml.

Evaporate the combined ether eluates containing the phenacetin to near dryness on a steam bath. Remove the flask from the heat and evaporate to dryness with the aid of a current of air. Pipet exactly 100.0 ml of methanol into the flask, stopper, and shake well to completely dissolve the residue. Pipet 10 ml of this

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solution into a 50 ml volumetric flask and dilute to volume with methanol. Determine the maximum absorbance of the sample and standard solution at approximately 248 nm in 1 cm quartz cells, using a suitable spectrophotometer with methanol as a blank.

Calculation:

$$\frac{Au}{As} \times \frac{S}{W} \times 5000 \times C = \text{mg of phenacetin per tablet}$$

Au = absorbance of sample
As = absorbance of standard
S = average weight of sample per tablet, in grams
W = weight of sample taken in grams

$$5000 = \text{dilution factor} = 50 \times \frac{100}{5} \times \frac{50}{10}$$

C = concentration of phenacetin standard in mg per ml.

4.5.1.3 Caffeine. The finished tablets shall be assayed for caffeine, as follows:

Reference standard. (Use purified water-washed solvents)

Prepare a reference standard solution containing caffeine USP reference standard with a known final concentration of approximately 0.02 mg per ml which has been dried at 80° C for 4 hours and accurately weighed, using chloroform as the solvent.

Place a 100 ml volumetric flask under column B and elute the caffeine by passing 3 consecutive 30 ml portions of purified water-washed chloroform through the column. Adjust the volume to 100 ml with chloroform, mix well, and determine the maximum absorbance of the sample and the standard solution at approximately 277 nm in 1 cm quartz cells, using a suitable spectrophotometer with chloroform as a blank.

Calculation.

$$\frac{Au}{As} \times \frac{S}{W} \times C \times 1000 = \text{mg caffeine per tablet}$$

Au = absorbance of sample
As = absorbance of standard
S = average sample weight per tablet, in grams
W = weight of sample powder used, in grams
C = concentration of caffeine standard in mg per ml

$$1000 = \text{dilution} = \frac{50 \times 100}{5}$$

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4.5.1.4 Butalbital. The finished tablet shall be assayed for butalbital, as follows:

Reference standard.

Prepare a reference standard solution of butalbital reference, NF having a known, final concentration of approximately 0.025 mg per ml, using butalbital which has been previously dried at 105° C for 2 hours and accurately weighed, using 0.1N ammonium hydroxide as the solvent.

After eluting the caffeine, place a 100 ml volumetric flask under column B and elute the butalbital by passing through the column, 10 ml of 10 percent glacial acetic acid in chloroform, followed by 90 ml of 1 percent glacial acetic acid in chloroform. Adjust the volume of the eluates to 100 ml with chloroform and mix well. Pipet exactly 25.0 ml of this solution into a 125 ml Erlenmeyer flask and evaporate to near dryness on the steam bath. Remove the flask from the heat, and evaporate to dryness with the aid of a current of air.

Pipet exactly 25.0 ml of 0.1N ammonium hydroxide into the flask, and shake well to completely dissolve the residue. Determine the maximum absorbance of the sample and the standard solution at approximately 240 nm in 1 cm quartz cells, using a suitable spectrophotometer with 0.1N ammonium hydroxide as a blank.

Calculation.

$$\frac{Au}{As} \times \frac{S}{W} \times C \times 1000 = \text{mg butalbital per tablet}$$

Au = absorbance of sample
As = absorbance of standard
S = average sample weight per tablet, in grams
W = weight of sample taken, in grams
C = concentration of butalbital standard in mg per ml

$$1000 = \text{dilution factor} = \frac{50 \times 100}{5}$$

4.5.2 Identity tests for active ingredients. The finished tablets shall be tested for the presence of aspirin, phenacetin, and caffeine in accordance with Identification Tests A, B, and C of the NF XIII monograph for Aspirin, Phenacetin, and Caffeine Tablets. The finished tablet shall be tested for the presence of butalbital by a suitable, reproducible method.

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4.5.2.1 As an alternate, a suitable reproducible thinlayer chromatography identification test for aspirin, phenacetin, caffeine and butalbital in Butalbital, Aspirin, Caffeine and Phenacetin Tablets shall be used.

4.5.3 Free salicylic acid determination.

Reagents.

Glacial acetic acid.
Purified water-washed chloroform (freshly prepared).
Ferric chloride solution, 2 percent, w/v $FeCl_3.6H_2O$ (freshly prepared)

NOTE: Use purified water-washed chloroform throughout the determination.

Procedure.

(1) To 7 grams of acid and purified water-washed, suitable chromatographic material, add 7 ml of ferric chloride solution and incorporate thoroughly by kneading with a flexible spatula blade. Transfer this mixture to a chromatographic tube and prepare the column in a suitable manner.

(2) Grind 10 tablets to a fine powder in a mortar and accurately weigh a quantity of finely powdered sample equivalent to 100 mg of aspirin. Place the powder in a beaker, add 10 ml of chloroform and stir for 5 minutes to dissolve the aspirin.

(3) Completely transfer the solution to the column using a total of 5 ml of chloroform in several small portions to rinse the beaker. Wash the column successively with three 25 ml portions of chloroform. Discard the washings. If a purple zone (salicylic acid) reached the bottom of the tube, discard the column and repeat the test, using a smaller sample size.

(4) Place a 50 ml volumetric flask under the column. Fit the flask with a small funnel containing a small cotton plug and a small amount of anhydrous sodium sulfate.

(5) Elute the salicylic acid with 5 ml of a 1:10 solution of glacial acetic acid in chloroform, followed by 44 ml of 1 percent (v/v) solution of glacial acetic acid in chloroform. Adjust to volume with chloroform.

(6) Prepare a standard salicylic acid solution with a concentration of 0.0125 mg per ml, using a 1 percent (v/v) solution of glacial acetic acid in chloroform.

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(7) Simultaneously determine the absorbances of the test and standard solutions at the maximum absorbance (approximately 310 nm), using a suitable spectrophotometer with chloroform as a blank.

Calculation.

The percent free salicylic acid (based on the required amount of aspirin in tablet) =

$$\frac{Au}{As} \times C \times \frac{50}{100} \times \frac{\text{weight equiv. to 100 mg aspirin} \times 100}{\text{weight of sample taken}}$$

Au = absorbance of sample
As = absorbance of standard
C = concentration of salicylic acid standard in mg per ml

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging requirements. The requirements for packaging shall be in accordance with all applicable requirements of PPP-C-186, and as specified herein.

5.2 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Unit of issue. One bottle containing 30 tablets, as specified; or one bottle containing 1000 tablets, as specified; or one box containing 30 individually packaged tablets, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.2.2 Level A.

5.2.2.1 Immediate container.

5.2.2.1.1 Sizes 1 and size 2. The immediate container for size 1 and size 2 shall be a commercially available bottle considered acceptable by the Food and Drug Administration (FDA) for the product contained therein and shall be of such compatibility that neither the contents nor the container are altered in any way by each other. The immediate container for size 1 shall have a minimum height of 48 mm, base to shoulder. In addition, the immediate container for size 1 shall be supplied with a child-proof closure.

5.2.2.1.2 Size 3. The immediate container for size 3 shall be a commercially available continuous roll strip package considered acceptable by the Food and Drug Administration (FDA) for the product contained therein and shall be of such compatibility that neither the contents nor the container are altered in any way by each other. Each tablet shall be sealed in its own pocket and so

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designed that the end pocket can be removed and the seal on the adjoining pocket shall not be disturbed. The individual pockets shall be consecutively numbered from one (1) to thirty (30). One roll of the thirty tablets shall be contained in a carton (box) as specified. The numbers on the strip package roll shall be in reverse order so that the first pocket removed shall be number thirty (30) and the second number shall be twenty-nine (29), etc. The carton shall have one transparent plastic window on the side opposite that of the label.

5.2.2.2 Unit package.

5.2.2.2.1 Size 1. Unit package is not required for size 1.

5.2.2.2.2 Size 2. At the option of the contractor each unit of size 2 may be packaged as specified in 5.2.5 of PPP-C-186.

5.2.2.2.3 Size 3. Each unit of size 3 shall be packaged as specified in in 5.2.5 of PPP-C-186.

5.2.2.3 Intermediate package.

5.2.2.3.1 Size 1. Twelve units of issue of size 1 shall be packaged as specified in 5.2.7.1 of PPP-C-186.

5.2.2.3.2 Size 2. An intermediate package is not required for size 2.

5.2.2.3.3 Size 3. Twelve units of issue of size 3 shall be packaged as specified in 5.2.7.1 of PPP-C-186.

5.3 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.3.1 Level A.

5.3.1.1 Size 1. Two hundred eighty-eight units of issue of size 1 shall be packed as specified in 5.4.4 of PPP-C-186.

5.3.1.2 Size 2. Twelve units of issue of size 2 shall be packed as specified in 5.4.4 of PPP-C-186.

5.3.1.3 Size 3. One hundred forty-four units of issue of size 3 shall be packed as specified in 5.4.4 of PPP-C-186.

5.3.2 Level B.

5.3.2.1 Size 1. Two hundred eighty-eight units of issue of size 1 shall be packed as specified in 5.4.3.1.1 of PPP-C-186.

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5.3.2.2 Size 2. Twelve units of issue of size 2 shall be packed as specified in 5.4.3.4 of PPP-C-186.

5.3.2.3 Size 3. One hundred forty-four units of issue of size 3 shall be packed as specified in 5.4.3.1.1 of PPP-C-186.

5.4 Marking.

5.4.1 Labeling. Labeling shall be in accordance with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder, and shall include the information required below:

5.4.1.1 Immediate container. Each immediate container label shall bear the following information:

(a) label information in accordance with commercial practice.

(b) For size 1 and size 2: the expiration date.

5.4.1.2 Unit package. Each unit package label shall bear the following information:

(a) label information in accordance with commercial practice.

(b) the National Stock Number.

(c) For size 3: the expiration date.

NOTES: (1) The National Stock Number need not be preceded by any prefix.

(2) Strip labeling may be used.

(3) Label adhesion test shall not apply.

(4) If a unit package is not supplied for sizes 1 and 2, the National Stock Number shall appear on the immediate container label.

5.4.2 Intermediate package. Each intermediate package of size 1 or size 3 shall be marked as specified in 5.5.3 of PPP-C-186. Type I shelf life markings shall be shown as specified in MIL-STD-129. Marking shall include the legend:

"STORE AT CONTROLLED ROOM TEMPERATURE 15° - 30°C (59° - 86°F)."

5.4.3 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked as specified in 5.5.4 of PPP-C-186. Type I shelf life marking shall be shown as specified in MIL-STD-129. Marking shall include the legend:

"STORE AT CONTROLLED ROOM TEMPERATURE 15° - 30°C (59° - 86°F)."

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6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(b) National Stock Number.

(c) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.2 and 5.3).

6.2 This specification covers the following items:

National Stock Number	Item Identification	Specification Designation
6505-00-117-8620	BUTALBITAL, ASPIRIN, CAFFEINE, AND PHENACETIN TABLETS, 30s	Size 1
6505-00-118-2129	BUTALBITAL, ASPIRIN, CAFFEINE, AND PHENACETIN TABLETS, Individually Sealed, 30s	Size 3
6505-00-962-4375	BUTALBITAL, ASPIRIN, CAFFEINE, AND PHENACETIN TABLETS, 1000s	Size 2

6.3 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revison to identify changes with respect to the previous issue, due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Review activity:
DoD - MB

Preparing activity:
DLA-DM

Project No. 6505-1897

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

MIL-B-37160A BUTALBITAL, ASPIRIN, CAFFEINE, AND PHENACETIN TABLETS

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

TELEPHONE NO.

DATE

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REPLACES EDITION OF 1 JAN 66 WHICH MAY BE USED

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